

Devil May Cry

was initially planned to be a sequel for the Resident Evil series

Esc



tradition of stopping and shooting compared to the usual run and gun mechanic, ensuring that you'd be blowing heads off zombies with laser-like precision. Carnage at its best.

And what carnage it is. Shoot an attacking dog and a zombie parasite splits it into half, giving you a new foe to get rid of. The game looks brutally gorgeous and packs a visceral punch with moments like these.

Everything from lighting effects to zombie pixels have been painstakingly rendered to make the most use of next-gen hardware. If this weren't enough, the music is well paced, with tracks selected according to the state of panic your character is in, it mixes in some percussion and operatic beats along with the usual electronic fare to great effect. When it comes to production values *Resident Evil 5* is as high as they come making the improbable zombies in broad daylight situation a tense, heart stopping affair that's multiplied several times over when you've got a friend playing along as well.

The cooperative mode is seamlessly built into the game. In fact there are sections where you'd feel that the game was made for coop and coop alone. However it's an undertaking that's best done via PSN or XBL as offline coop features screens that significantly shrunk down (unless you fancy playing at 480p).

Other grouses include a cover system that's quite useless and an inventory system that's tougher to manage than a pair of Bollywood starlets.

These minor flaws aside, *Resident Evil 5* is an epic game that is worth playing for anyone even remotely interested in the survival horror franchise. Even if you're not, it's still worth a try regardless. ■



Developer: Capcom
Publisher: Capcom
Platforms: Xbox 360, PlayStation 3
Score: 8/10